Michael Jackson Made Me Do It

by Gregg Moeller



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LURLEEN. Mavis…MAVIS! I got a question for ya.

MAVIS. Lurleen. It is 5 AM. Questions are illegal from 3-6.

LURLEEN. Mavis—when do you know you or some significant udder is possessed by…SATAN?

MAVIS. Significant udder? You got a cow with pentagram carved on it?

LURLEEN. No, no no…other—other!

MAVIS. Other what?

LURLEEN. Seeg-niff-ihh-CANT other!

(*Pause*)

MAVIS. This train of thought derailed way too close to the station, Lurleen.

LURLEEN. Satan! SAY-TAN!

MAVIS. What about him?

LURLEEN. The Beast! The Demon! Beelzebub! The Deceiver! The Father of Lies!

MAVIS. You know you are also describing my ex-husband Jo-Jo. Get to the point, Lurleen!

LURLEEN. He has struck us, Mavis. Struck us deep and true!

MAVIS. Struck us? Is the carbon monoxide filter on your gas generator backed up again?

LURLEEN. In his Satanic glory, Lucifer has struck down one of our own. Struck him down like a jogging nun at a Hell's Angels rally.

MAVIS. Nun at a…Lurleen—get to the POINT!

LURLEEN. It is my brother Delbert. Delbert is under the scourge of the Serpent of Old!

MAVIS. Delbert? He ain't possessed…he's in detox. And that ain't Satan—that's Old Turkey.

LURLEEN. He was released today and he arrived on my doorsteps bridegroom of Beelzebub.

MAVIS. He's been married four times. And to be blunt, Beelzebub is probably a step up from the previous four.

LURLEEN. Shush. DELBERT! Get out here and show you's possessed like I says you were!

MAVIS. Oh, for the love of…

(*DELBERT enters with a wide eyed, glazed look on his face*)

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MAVIS. Delbert, you look like you've been ridden all day and put up wet.

DELBERT. She Told Me Her Name Was Billie Jean,
As She Caused A Scene
Then Every Head Turned
With Eyes That Dreamed
Of Being The One
Who Will Dance
On The Floor
In The Round
She Says I Am The One,
But The Kid Is Not My Son

LURLEEN. You see? SATAN!

DELBERT. People Always Told Me Be Careful Of What You Do
And Don't Go Around Breaking Young Girls' Hearts
And Mother Always Told Me Be Careful Of Who You Love
And Be Careful Of What You Do 'Cause The Lie Becomes
The Truth

MAVIS. That ain't Satan. That's Michael Jackson.

LURLEEN. Close enough, Mavis. Close enough.

DELBERT. Billie Jean Is Not My Lover
She's Just A Girl Who Claims That I Am The One

LURLEEN. Lord help us. The Rapture is upon us!

DELBERT. But The Kid Is Not My Son

LURLEEN. It's the end of the world as we know it—and I don't feel fine, Mavis!

MAVIS. Lurleen, I'm pretty certain that in the Book of Revelation Michael Jackson is remarkably absent. Nickelback? Well…

LURLEEN. It is the end of the world. The EE-cops-a liss!

MAVIS. The whut?

LURLEEN. ECOPALYSS! You know, the Four Freshman!

MAVIS. You mean, uh-pock-a-lips. And that's the four Horsemen.

LURLEEN. I don't give a rat's bladder if they're riding ten speed bikes—Delbert is a Soldier of Doom, and the Devil's using him like Jeff Dunham!

MAVIS. I see that he got divorced.

LURLEEN. Really? He seems like such a nice guy.

MAVIS. I just love Achmed. "Shut up! I KEEL YOU!"

LURLEEN. I like that pickle guy. The Mexican.

MAVIS. That's a jalapeno. And that's racist.

LURLEEN. I am NOT racist! I have a Whitney Houston album!

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DELBERT: Ben, you're always running here and there
(here and there)
You feel you're not wanted anywhere
(anywhere)…

LURLEEN. Oh, good Lord—she's moved onto "Ben"!

DELBERT: I used to say, I and me
Now it's us, now it's we
(I used to say, I and me)
(now it's us, now it's we)

MAVIS. Oh, my stars and garters.

DELBERT: Ben, most people would turn you away
I don't listen to a word they say

MAVIS. This IS serious, Lurleen--Delbert's spouting lyrics about a pet rat.

DELBERT: I'm sure they'd think again
If they had a friend like Ben

LURLEEN. "Ben" is about a rat? Really?

MAVIS. Focus on the topic at hand, Lurleen…Delbert—DELBERT!

DELBERT: (a friend) Like Ben
(like Ben)
Like Ben

LURLEEN. Delbert loves a rat named Ben?

MAVIS. That's not our Delbert talkin'—that's Michael Jackson.
Michael Jackson is Satan.

LURLEEN. Mavis—what will we do? I don't want to see what happens when he gets to "Thriller"!

MAVIS. Lurleen…we gotta think…what would ELVIS do?

BOTH. Our Lord and Savior.

LURLEEN. Depends. Do you mean Fat Vegas Elvis or 50's Elvis?

DELBERT: They print my message in the Saturday Sun
I had to tell them I ain't second to none

MAVIS. We can't wait—we gotta exorcism Delbert—now!

LURLEEN. But how?

MAVIS. We need an old priest and a young priest.

LURLEEN. That only works with Linda Blair. We're facing the Acopmalice!

MAVIS. The spirit of Elvis compels you!

BOTH. THE SPIRIT OF ELVIS COMPELS YOU!

DELBERT: And I told about equality and it's true
Either you're wrong or you're right…hee hee.

LURLEEN. Gosh all-Mighty—"Black or White"!

.

DELBERT: But, if you're thinkin' about my baby
It don't matter if you're black or white
LURLEEN. Humanity is DOOMED. Mavis!
MAVIS. Not yet. You know what we need to do!
LURLEEN. You mean…
MAVIS. Exactly!

(*MAVIS and LURLEEN say their lines in unison while DELBERT says his at the same time.)*

BOTH. You ain't nutin but a hound dog, Michael Jackson!
Lying all the time!
You ain't nuthin but a hound dog, Michael Jackson!
Crying all the time!
You ain't never caught a rabbit—you ain't no friend of mine!
DELBERT: ABC It's easy as, 1 2 3
As simple as, do re mi
A B C, 1 2 3
Baby, you and me girl
LURLEEN. Michael Jackson is too strong, Mavis. Stronger than Elvis!

(DELBERT starts moving about the room, as if floating)

DELBERT: (*says the following while LURLEEN and MAVIS talk*)
Say, say, say what you want but don't play games with my affection…
LURLEEN. MAVIS! Delbert is lemonaiding!
MAVIS. Lemonaiding?
LURLEEN. Levertating? He's LEVERTATING!!!
MAVIS. The WORD is LEVITATING! And I can see! When your brother starts flying around a living room, it's a bit hard not to notice!
LURLEEN. Delbert! You stop laminating around my trailer! Those ceiling panels are new!
DELBERT: Take, take, take what you need but don't leave me with no direction…
MAVIS. I have had JUST ABOUT ENOUGH of this! You get down here this **INSTANT**, you evil flying Michael Jackson Delbert!
DELBERT: (Said while L and M talk)
All alone I sit home by the phone waiting for you baby
(*baby*)

.

Through the years how can you stand to hear my pleading for you dear?

LURLEEN. Should I hit 'em with my tennis racket?
MAVIS. (*pause*) You play tennis?
LURLEEN. Not really. I mostly use it to kill bats.
MAVIS. Now, THAT has to be a sight!
LURLEEN. But I don't want to swat Delbert—even if he's possessed by Michael Jackson. And looking like a moth about to kamikaze a bug zapper.
DELBERT: You know I'm crying, ooh ooh ooh ooh ooh
MAVIS. Oh, for cryin' out loud—MICHAEL JACKSON! Get down here before we nail you with this bat-killin' tennis racket.

(DELBERT stops levitating)

MAVIS. Quick—you still got your Intranet?
LURLEEN. Sure!
MAVIS. Search "How to do an exorcism in a double wide trailer after Elvis has failed"!
DELBERT: Because I'm bad, I'm bad come on
You know I'm bad, I'm bad come on, you know
You know I'm bad, I'm bad come on, you know
LURLEEN. That's too long!
MAVIS. Just type, Lurleen!
LURLEEN. It's times like this I miss "Ask Jeeves"..
MAVIS. TYPE!
LURLEEN. Okay (*types slowly—hunt and peck*) How do you spell exorcism?
MAVIS. Move over! (*pause*) Boy…you have an interesting search history, Lurleen…"Garth Brooks nekkid"?
LURLEEN. NEVER MIND THAT! Type!
DELBERT: And the whole world has to
Answer right now
Just to tell you once again
Who's bad
MAVIS. Okay—here we go…HEY! When they do exorcisms in Japan they make you take a bath in vodka to "cleanse the body and spirit"…
LURLEEN. We ain't in JAPAN, Mavis! Focus!
MAVIS. Excuse ME for tryin' to educate you…
LURLEEN. What does it say?

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MAVIS. It says, "Tell it to go away."

LURLEEN. What? That's it? Don't we need holy water and a Bible?

MAVIS. Whatcha got?

LURLEEN. Diet Coke and a copy of "The Elvis Cookbook".

MAVIS. That's it? You don't have a Bible?

LURLEEN. I'm a light reader.

MAVIS. Beggars can't be choosers. Let's do this!

BOTH. The Spirit of Elvis's cookbook compels you!

MAVIS. Pour the Diet Coke on her!

LURLEEN. I most certainly will not. I just rug-doctored my carpet!

DELBERT: 'Cause this is thriller, thriller night
And no one's gonna save you from the beast about to Strike

LURLEEN. Oh,no…THRILLER!

DELBERT: You know it's thriller, thriller night
You're fighting for your life inside a killer
Thriller tonight

MAVIS. DO IT!! Heed our righteous Diet Coke, Satan Michael Jackson!

LURLEEN. (*lamely pours Diet Coke*) Heed this diet cola beverage, Satan! Heed! Heed!

MAVIS. What does "heed" mean?

LURLEEN. I think it is the past tense of "Hide".

MAVIS. How can it mean "hide" when you're pouring Diet Coke on Satan?

LURLEEN. Don't yell at me! I've never exorcised Michael Jackson before! One doesn't normally plan for such events!

DELBERT: You better run, you better do what you can
Don't wanna see no blood, don't be a macho man
You wanna be tough, better do what you can
So beat it, but you wanna be bad

LURLEEN. It's no use! Michael Jackson has beaten us!

MAVIS. I will not concede defeat to "the KING' of Pop!

LURLEEN. Read from the HOLY COOKBOOK! It's our last chance!

MAVIS. The Official Elvis Peanut Butter, Banana and Bacon Sandwich Recipe—ahem…

LURLEEN. Heed the recipe, Satan Michael Jackson!

MAVIS. Shut up, Lurleen! AHEM…Place 2 pieces of white bread in the toaster on a light setting. Heat skillet over medium heat with 2 tablespoons butter. While the bread is toasting, in a small bowl, using a fork mash the ripe banana until it reaches a smooth consistency. Using a knife, take both…

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(while MAVIS reads the recipe, DELBERT chants the following)

DELBERT: Just beat it, beat it, beat it, beat it
No one wants to be defeated
Showin' how funky strong is your fight
It doesn't matter who's wrong or right….

MAVIS. Oh for cryin' out loud—I've had enough! Time to get physical! FEEL The WRATH OF ELVIS, MICHAEL JACKSON!

(MAVIS hits DELBERT with the cookbook—DELBERT immediately snaps out of spell)

DELBERT: Hey-hey-hey….HEY! What—What the HADES are you doin'?

MAVIS. Speak not thy lies, Satan! (hits him again)

DELBERT: I am NOT Satan!

MAVIS. Then, away with thee, Michael Jackson!

LURLEEN. Hit him again! He's still twitchin'!

DELBERT: What the…I'm Delbert Flanagan, Mavis!

MAVIS. Lies, Beelzebub!

DELBERT: STOP HITTIN' ME!

MAVIS. You not Michael Jackson no more?

DELBERT: I most certainly am not.

LURLEEN. Then will you kindly explain what's going on?

MAVIS. Be thorough. Or I'll brain ya with this holy cookbook again.

DELBERT: I got out of detox, and I sort of…celebrated at the Dixie Lounge and Grill. Stuff got fuzzy after that.

LURLEEN. That aint the point of detox, Delbert.

DELBERT: Well, if I stop drinkin', will you stop hitting me with cookbooks?

MAVIS. Only if Elvis --

ALLURLEEN. --Our Lord and Savior—

MAVIS. --Deems it so.

DELBERT: I'll take my chances. Can I go now? I 've got a massive headache from that cookbook….jeez Louise…

MAVIS. Well, it looks like we—with the help of our Lord and Savior Elvis—have saved Thelma, and probably the universe from the perverted eeee-vil of Michael Jackson. Pretty, good…huh, Lurleen? Lurleen?

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LURLEEN. You and I must make a pact,
MAVIS. Oh, no.
LURLEEN. we must bring salvation back
MAVIS. Lurleen, NO!
LURLEEN. Where there is love…
BOTH. I'll be there…

